

Book	Administrative Guideline Manual
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Revised Guideline - Vol. 43, No. 2

5460D - DIPLOMA SEALS

The Board of Education authorizes students to earn the following seal(s) to fulfill State requirements to earn a diploma.

A. Community Service Seal

The Board believes that high-quality community service experiences help prepare students for success in the workplace by allowing them to apply academic, leadership, and technical skills in a real-life setting. Community service also connects students with the community in a positive way and teaches them to become good citizens.

A student may earn a Community Service Seal by completing a minimum of **forty (40)** hours of community service during high school in a high-quality community service experience.

A high-quality community service experience achieves the following:

1. helps students make invaluable connections in their community
2. gives students an opportunity to explore possible career options in the public, nonprofit, and philanthropic sectors and gain valuable work skills
3. exposes students to the needs of their community and promotes an understanding of, and the value in, civic engagement as well as volunteerism
4. provides students with an opportunity to acquire and demonstrate social and emotional skills, academic knowledge, leadership, professionalism, and critical reasoning

Community service must be completed with an approved charitable organization which is preferably located and registered as a nonprofit organization in Ohio. Students may verify whether a nonprofit organization is registered in Ohio on the Ohio Attorney General's website at

<https://charitableregistration.ohioattorneygeneral.gov/charities/Research-Charities.aspx>.

Students must submit the following to their counselor for approval:

1. **log of hours (self-tracked)**
2. a description of the proposed community service activities, including a list of duties, responsibilities, and learning outcomes (scope of work)
3. name and description of the organization
4. a timeline for completing community service hours
5. **provide contact information for supervisor of activity**

B. Fine/Performing Arts Seal

The Board believes that participation in fine and performing arts programs supports the development of critical skills such as creativity, sensory processing, communication, problem-solving, cultural awareness, and expression. It also helps students gain confidence that will assist them throughout life.

A student may earn a Fine/Performing Arts Seal by earning at least **four (4)** credits of approved fine arts program

electives in one (1) of the following disciplines: visual arts, dance, drama/theatre, music, or media arts during high school.

Students may also earn the seal by participating in **two (2)** full seasons of a Board-approved fine or performing arts extracurricular activity in one (1) of the recognized disciplines. One (1) season of extracurricular activity will be considered the equivalent of one (1) class credit toward earning the seal. In order for participation in a fine/performing arts extracurricular activity to count toward earning the seal, students must participate in the entire scheduled season of the activity. Participation must be verified by the program advisor or coach. Students may earn two (2) credits in one (1) year by participating in a co-curricular activity such as choir, theatre, or band. One (1) credit will be achieved by earning a passing score in the class component, and one (1) credit will be earned by participating during the entire season of the extracurricular activity component.

C. **Citizenship Seal**

The Citizenship Seal is a state-defined seal. Students will earn the Citizenship Seal by demonstrating knowledge and skills through course work, on Ohio's State Tests, Advanced Placement and International Baccalaureate courses and tests, or in College Credit Plus coursework.

D. **College-Ready Seal**

To earn the College and Career Readiness Seal, students must earn remediation-free scores on the ACT or SAT, as outlined by the Ohio Department of Education and Workforce ("DEW").

[College and Career Readiness Test Information](#)

E. **Honors Diploma Seal**

The Honors Seal is a state-defined seal. Students will earn the Honors Seal by satisfying the requirements for one (1) of six (6) honors diplomas outlined below:

1. Academic Honors Diploma;
2. Career-Tech Honors Diploma;
3. International Baccalaureate Honors Diploma;
4. STEM Honors Diploma;
5. Arts Honors Diploma;
6. Civics and Social Sciences Honors Diploma.

F. **Industry-Recognized Credential Seal**

The Industry-Recognized Credential Seal is a state-defined seal. To earn the Industry-Recognized Credential Seal, students must earn an Ohio Department of Education and Workforce approved industry-recognized credential or group of credentials aligned to a career that is considered in-demand in Ohio.

G. **Military Seal**

The Military Seal is a state-defined seal. A student will earn the Military Seal when they provide evidence of enlistment in a branch of the United States Armed Forces. Students also may receive this seal if they participate in a Junior Reserve Officer Training Corps ("JROTC") program, appointed into a United States military service academy, or received a scholarship into the Reserve Officer Training Corps ("ROTC").

H. **OhioMeansJobs - Readiness Seal**

To earn the OhioMeansJobs-Readiness Seal, motivated high school students must demonstrate specific professional skills required for success in the workplace. Students must work with at least three (3) experienced and trusted mentors who validate the demonstration of these skills in school, work, or the community.

I. **Science Seal**

The Science Seal is a state-defined seal. Students will earn the Science Seal by demonstrating knowledge and skills through course work, Ohio's State Tests, Advanced Placement and International Baccalaureate courses and tests, or in College Credit Plus coursework.

J. **Technology Seal**

The Technology Seal is a state-defined seal. Students who earn Ohio's Technology Seal will understand the global

impact of technology and use it to design solutions and communicate ideas. Students will earn the Technology Seal by demonstrating knowledge and skills on Advanced Placement and International Baccalaureate courses and tests, through College Credit Plus coursework, or by completing a qualifying technology course.

K. **Seal of Biliteracy**

A Seal of Biliteracy recognizes graduating seniors who can demonstrate high levels of proficiency in English and at least one (1) other language. A school or district gives this award by following state-established guidelines.

L. **Student Engagement Seal**

The Board believes that meaningful participation in Board-approved extracurricular activities helps to develop a well-rounded student who is more engaged in the school community.

Students may earn a Student Engagement Seal by participating in at least **two - per year (2 per year)** Board-approved extracurricular activities during high school. Eligible activities include participation in a District athletic program, Board-recognized school club, or student government.

In order for participation to count toward earning the seal, students must participate in the entire scheduled season of the activity for at least one (1) school year. Participation must be verified by the program advisor or coach.

All earned diploma seals will be affixed to a student's official transcript.